

Mission Control: Financial Tracker

OpenClaw Masterclass — Lesson Guide & All Prompts

What you'll build in this lesson:

- **Financial Tracker screen** — track subscriptions, API costs, and revenue in one place
- **Four summary cards** — Monthly Subscriptions, Total Spend, Total Revenue, Net Position
- **Server-side persistence** — entries saved to finance.json so data sticks around
- **Weekly Telegram reminder** — automated prompt every Sunday to log your spending
- **Clear picture of finances** — know exactly where you stand with your AI setup costs

All Prompts Used In This Lesson

Copy and paste these prompts into Telegram in order.

Prompt 1: Build the Financial Tracker

Add a Financial Tracker screen to our Mission Control. I want to see three main sections: my monthly subscriptions like ChatGPT, Claude, OpenRouter credits, and any other tools I'm using, my variable API costs where I can log how much I'm spending on API calls each week, and any revenue I'm making from my work. For each subscription I want to see the name, the monthly cost, and the renewal date. For API costs I want a simple log where I can add entries with a date, a description, and an amount. And for revenue I want the same thing - date, source, and amount. At the top show me a quick summary with total monthly subscriptions, total spend this month, total revenue this month, and my net position. Make it match the same dark style as everything else. After making the changes, rebuild for production and restart the server.

After the agent confirms, refresh your dashboard and click Financial Tracker in the sidebar.

Prompt 2: Set Up Weekly Spend Reminder Cron Job

You've created cron jobs for me before - like the daily Gmail summary, the morning brief, and the heartbeat automation. Use the same approach now. Just create an OpenClaw cron job that runs every Sunday at 6pm Europe/London and sends me a Telegram message reminding me to log my weekly spend for OpenRouter, Anthropic, OpenAI, and Moonshot into the Financial Tracker.

If your agent hesitates saying it can't create cron jobs from this session, remind it of cron jobs it's already built for you. It will then set it up through the normal OpenClaw cron system.

Prompt 3: Fix Summary Cards Bug (if needed)

There's a bug in the Financial Tracker. I added a revenue entry and it's showing in the Revenue list on the right. But the Total Revenue This Month card at the top still shows 0.00. The Net Position card is also wrong. Fix the summary cards so they properly add up all revenue entries. After making the changes, rebuild for production and restart the server.

Use this if revenue entries don't show up in the Total Revenue This Month summary card after you add them.

Can We Pull API Costs Automatically?

This is the question most students ask. Here's the honest answer for each provider:

Provider	Can We Automate?
OpenRouter	Only with a management key (not a standard API key). Most people only have standard keys, so this needs manual logging.
Anthropic	Requires an Admin API key, only available on Team or Enterprise plans. Not available on individual accounts.
OpenAI	Same as Anthropic - requires admin API key from Team or Enterprise plan.
Moonshot	No public usage API available. Always manual.
Monthly Subscriptions	Always manual - but you only enter them once and they stay put.

The practical solution: set up a weekly Telegram reminder (Prompt 2 above). Every Sunday evening you get a message listing each provider, and you log the weekly spend manually. Simple, works for everyone, no extra setup needed.

Summary Cards Reference

The four coloured cards at the top of the Financial Tracker give you an instant snapshot:

Card	Colour	What It Shows
Monthly Subscriptions	Blue	Your total fixed monthly tool costs
Total Spend This Month	Red	Subscriptions + all API usage combined
Total Revenue This Month	Green	All work and business income logged
Net Position	Purple	Revenue minus spend - are you profitable?

What To Log (Example)

Here's a worked example of what your Financial Tracker might look like after a month of use:

Monthly Subscriptions

Name	Monthly Cost	Renewal Date
Claude Pro	\$20	15th
ChatGPT Plus	\$20	5th
Hostinger VPS	\$8	22nd
Domain renewal	\$1	3rd

Variable API Costs

Date	Description	Amount
Week 1	OpenRouter weekly spend	\$4.50
Week 1	Anthropic API calls	\$12.30
Week 2	OpenRouter weekly spend	\$6.20

Revenue

Date	Source	Amount
Today	Client Project 1	\$4,000
Today	Claude AI Operating System x 3	\$6,000

Always Verify Your Cron Jobs

After setting up the Sunday reminder, head to the Calendar screen to check it actually appeared. If you don't see it there, tell your agent:

You said you'd schedule that weekly reminder but I don't see it on the Calendar. Set it up properly.

The Calendar is your source of truth. If a cron job isn't there, it's not actually scheduled.

Tips & Troubleshooting

Situation	What to do
Summary cards show wrong totals	Use Prompt 3 to fix the bug. Describe exactly what numbers you're seeing vs what they should be.
Agent hesitates on creating cron job	Remind it of cron jobs it's already built for you (daily Gmail summary, morning brief, heartbeat automation).
Revenue entry disappears after refresh	Check that server-side persistence is working. Ask agent: "Is finance.json being saved properly?"
Can't see finance.json in Documents	That's normal - data files are system files, not user documents. They don't show up in the Documents screen.
Subscription renewal date format unclear	Just enter the day number (e.g. "15" for the 15th of the month). Keep it simple.
Want to automate OpenRouter pulls	You'd need an OpenRouter management key (different from regular API key). Most people stick with manual logging.
Forgot to log last week's spend	Just add it with last week's date. The Financial Tracker doesn't care when you enter data, only what date you set.
Mission Control crashed	Tell your agent: "Mission Control is down. Restart it on port 3007 in production mode."

What You've Built

- ✓ Financial Tracker screen with three sections - subscriptions, API costs, revenue
- ✓ Four coloured summary cards showing totals and net position
- ✓ Server-side persistence - data saved to finance.json
- ✓ Weekly Sunday reminder cron job on Telegram
- ✓ Clear understanding of what can and can't be automated

✓ A simple routine for tracking your AI setup costs and revenue